First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Monday: 2pm-4pm; Tuesday 9am-2pm; Wednesday 10am-Noon; Thursday 9am-2pm; Friday 10am-Noon.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: Tues. & Wed, 9am-12pm, and by appt.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Sandy Cristman

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

Point camera at me
givelify Snap-to-Give

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

February 11, 2024

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Special Guest Preacher, Kent Gramm
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Sixth Sunday After Epiphany January 21, 2024

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words**:**
"The new heavens and the new earth are not replacements for the old ones; they are transfigurations of them. The redeemed order is not the created order forsaken; it is the created order – all of it – raised and glorified." — Robert Farrar Capon

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *In The G arden* arr. Conrady

Welcome and Announcements

Call To Worship

All: Within this community

One: We experience God's unconditional love

All: Within this community

One: We rejoice in the risen Christ

All: Within this community

One: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

All: Within this community

One: We join together in worship

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and a full pantry, fridge, and freezer stock of food.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

- ➔ Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- ➔ First Congregational Church of St Albans
- ➔ Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- ➔ Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- ➔ Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- ➔ As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative. Including, Adorn Aprons and Franklin County Quilt Guild.

WH works with local housing case workers from:

- ➢ F/GI Community Action
- ➢ Voices Against Violence
- ➢ Samaritan House
- ➢ Restorative Justice Center
- ➢ Pathways
- ➢ Reach-Up

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**
Mighty God, you call to us. You call to the heavens and to the earth in covenant. And so we call to you: be present as we worship. Gather us, that we may hear your voice and respond to your ways of righteousness. We pray in the power of your Holy Spirit. Amen.

Hymn*
"As With Gladness Those of Old" NCH 159

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Litany)**
One: God invites us to come to worship as our whole selves. God offers us a new beginning day by day and week by week. Trusting in God, we pray for transformation and new life:
All: Mighty God, you call to us and summon us to live in covenant and walk in righteousness, yet we forsake your covenant and walk in ways of injustice, ignorance, or disdain. Your beauty shines forth in creation, yet we abuse and tarnish what you have created. May we be willing to do the hard thing: M ay we see what is happening. May we see what we do. Renew us. Let us receive a double portion of your renewing spirit. Amen.

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Special Music *Under a Tree* S. Conrady

Scripture Readings
Colossians 1: 13-20 & Mark 9: 2-7

Morning Reflection
Who Are You?

Hymn*

"Precious Lord, Take My Hand" NCH 472

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"Softly and Tenderly" NCH 449

Benediction

Postlude *Wherever You Go* W. Priory

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- ★ Kent Gramm Thank You for preaching while Pastor Jessica is away!
- ★ Larry Bruce Thank You for connecting us with Dr. Kevin Dirth- our new interim music director!

Informational Meeting

February 11, 2024

Notice is hereby given that an Informational Meeting of the First Congregational Church of St. Albans, Vermont will be held on February 11 th, 2024 immediately following the Sunday service. This notice is given in accordance with the by-laws requiring three Informational Meetings a year, one of which is to be held in February and two weeks prior notice for such meetings.

Bible Study

Our next Bible Study will meet on Feb. 14

Bible Study 7:00- 8:00 pm

Text: Genesis 9:8-17

You can join us at any time, call Pastor Jessica for the link.

Open Mic Night

February 17

See Greg for more info: 324-0308

Pastor Jessica will be on Vacation from Feb. 5-13